

A

At, on and in

At a point or place, e.g. I met her **at** the bus stop. He's **at** work at the moment.

On a surface, e.g. The book's **on** the desk. They sat **on** the floor. I put the picture **on** the wall.

In an area, space, or inside something, e.g. He's **in** the kitchen. She lives **in** Warsaw/Poland. The knife's **in** the top drawer.

Common mistakes

I met them **at** the airport. (NOT I met them ~~on~~ the airport.)

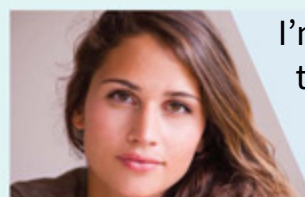
There's a computer **on** my desk. (NOT There's a computer ~~in~~ my desk.)

The conference is being held **in** Delhi. (NOT The conference is being held ~~at~~ Delhi.)

B

Where exactly?

I know they live **in** Danvers Street, and I think they're **at** number twenty-three.



I'm sure there's a chemist on the left **before** the bank. [first there is a chemist, and then a bank; *opp* **after**]



Their house is **beyond** the farm [on the other side of the farm], **by** [near] the old church.



I saw your bike in the back garden **against** the wall. [touching the wall]



They've just bought a house **right** [exactly] **beside/by** [next to] the river.



I found your phone on the sofa **beneath/underneath** a pile of cushions. [under]



Their office is **above** the shop (*opp* **below**).



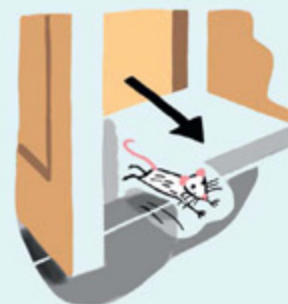
You can just see the top of the building **among** the trees. [somewhere in the middle of the trees]

C

Movement

We came **over** the bridge (*opp* **under**), then **through** the tunnel and **round** the lake.

The mouse ran **out of** the back door (*opp* **into**), **towards** the gate, then disappeared **down** a hole.



The woman came **after** us [followed in order to catch us], but we managed to climb **into** the back of my dad's van. Fortunately she went **past** the van and didn't see us.

